WOLFE

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FREE CHECKLIST · USA · CANADA · UK

SCAM RED-FLAG CHECKLIST

Ten warning signs of a dating scam, what to do if something feels wrong, and where to report it.

CHECKLIST

10 RED FLAGS

Tick any that apply to someone you met online. One flag is a reason to slow down. **Two or more: stop and talk to someone you trust.**

- [ ] Their photos look too perfect, or a reverse image search finds the same pictures under another name.
- [ ] They want to move from the app to WhatsApp, Telegram or text within days.
- [ ] They say "I love you" or call you "soulmate" very quickly, before you have met.
- [ ] They always have a reason not to video call or meet in person.
- [ ] They live or work far away: overseas, military, a ship, an oil rig, "a doctor abroad".
- [ ] Their story has gaps or changes when you ask simple questions.
- [ ] A sudden emergency: hospital bill, customs fee, plane ticket, "business problem".
- [ ] They ask for money, gift cards, crypto, wire transfers or your bank details, in any amount.
- [ ] They pressure you to act fast, or to keep the relationship secret from family and friends.
- [ ] They bring up an investment or trading app ("my cousin made a fortune").

REMEMBER

Real people will happily video call, meet in a public place, and let you take your time. Scammers cannot.

IF SOMETHING FEELS WRONG

WHAT TO DO

1. Stop	Do not send more money or personal information. Do not confront them: it can make things worse.
2. Keep evidence	Screenshots, usernames, phone numbers, payment details, dates.
3. Call your bank	Call your bank or card provider straight away. Speed matters.
4. Report	US: reportfraud.ftc.gov (FTC) and ic3.gov (FBI). UK: Action Fraud / Report Fraud. Elsewhere: your local police or consumer authority. Also report the profile on the dating app.
5. Tell someone	A friend, family member or helpline. Scammers rely on shame and secrecy.
6. Be kind to yourself	It is not your fault. Skilled criminals do this for a living.

SAFE-MEETING RULES

- Video call before you meet.
- Meet in a public place and tell a friend where you are going.
- Use your own transport.
- Keep your address, workplace and finances private until you really know the person.

THE NUMBERS

People 60+ reported about $2.4 billion in fraud losses to the FTC in 2024 (all fraud types). Verify current figures on ftc.gov. Dorian Wolfe is an AI-generated character. General information, not legal or financial advice.

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WHERE TO REPORT

Stop contact. Do not send more money. Tell your bank or card company straight away, keep the messages and screenshots, then report it. You are not the first, and reporting helps.

USA	Report to the FTC at **reportfraud.ftc.gov** and to the FBI Internet Crime Complaint Center at **ic3.gov**. If you sent money, tell your bank or card company straight away.
Canada	Report to the **Canadian Anti-Fraud Centre: 1-888-495-8501**, or online at antifraudcentre-centreantifraude.ca. If you lost money, also contact your local police and your bank.
UK	Report to **Report Fraud: reportfraud.police.uk, 0300 123 2040** (England, Wales and Northern Ireland; in Scotland call Police Scotland on 101). It replaced Action Fraud in December 2025. To reach your own bank's fraud team, **dial 159**.

CHECK FIRST

Numbers and hours change. If one fails, search the service's official website.